

The **\$210,000** BI Trap.

How a \$7M New York brand got enterprise reporting without sacrificing 30% of their net profit.



5-Day Deployment • \$0 Software Licenses

Zero Snowflake compute. Zero Power BI viewer taxes.



Charlton Smith
Appleify Automation

SWIPE →

\$210,000 / year

Quoted for Snowflake, dbt Cloud, Fivetran & Power BI.

\$

Store Revenue: \$7,000,000

Healthy top-line sales across Shopify and Amazon.

!

Net Profit: \$600k – \$750k

The proposed SaaS stack would have consumed 30% of their annual profit.

Blind on Margins. Trapped by Costs.

THE OPERATIONAL NEED

Board presentation in 5 days.

- Running on raw CSV exports
- No single view of gross margin
- Unable to track multi-channel ROI

THE ENTERPRISE PITCH

6-Month Implementation

- \$210,000/yr recurring SaaS
- \$160k/yr engineer required
- Heavy vendor lock-in

The 5-Day Open Lakehouse.

Enterprise performance running directly on open file standards.

1

Storage

Google Cloud Storage (Parquet)

\$4.80 / mo

2

Compute

Embedded DuckDB (Vectorized SQL)

In-Memory

3

Semantics

Cube.js Metric Governance

Pre-Aggregated

4

Executive UI

Metabase OSS Dashboard

\$0 Licenses

\$4.80 / month

Storage cost for 30 million order transactions.



Apache Parquet Format

Columnar compression reduces raw CSV storage by 10×.



Zero Idle Compute

No warehouse instances running 24/7. You only pay for stored bytes.

1.11 seconds

Direct vectorized scan across multi-year order history.



DuckDB Vectorized Engine

Processes analytical queries in-memory using HTTP range requests.



Zero Cluster Maintenance

Serverless SQL engine with zero database clusters to patch or tune.

48ms

Sub-second executive dashboard response time.



KPIs Defined Once in Code

Gross profit, GMV, and AOV governed centrally via Cube.js.

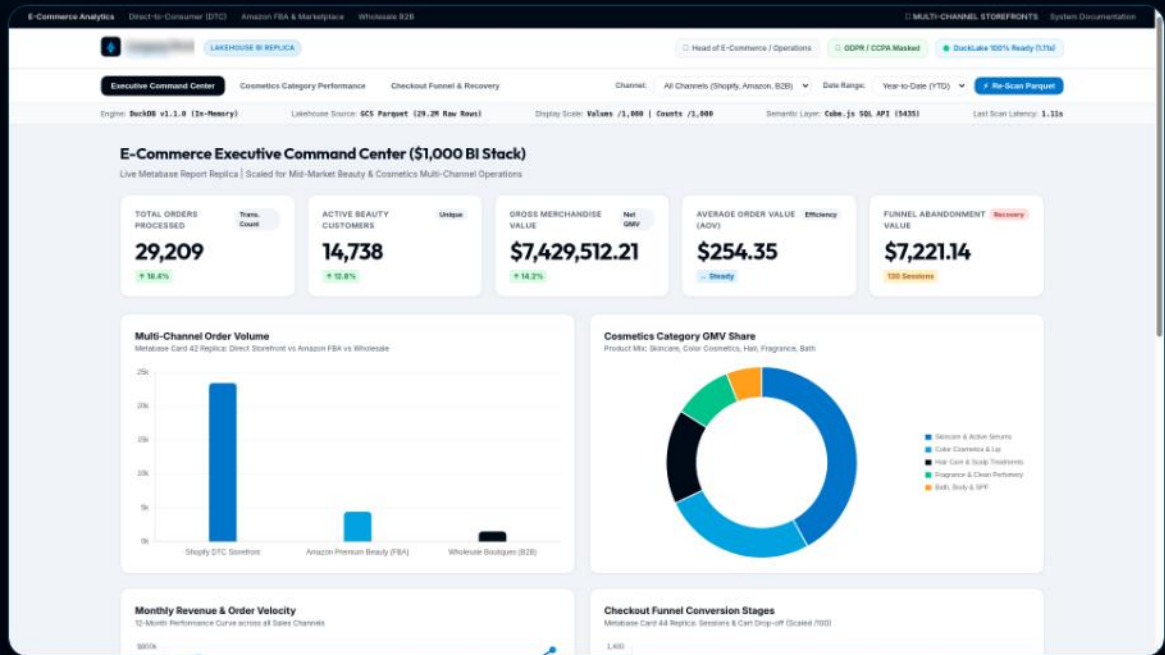


Automated Pre-Aggregations

Common rollups cached automatically for instantaneous filter changes.

The Executive Command Center.

Live multi-channel visibility across Shopify, Amazon, and Wholesale.



⚡ 1.11s Scan Time

✓ 100% Client Data Privacy

Unlimited Users

Zero per-seat software licensing fees.



Clean Executive Interface

Real-time channel breakdown, gross margins, and SKU performance.



Built-in Privacy & Security

Customer PII masked dynamically before rendering.

The Financial Difference.

ENTERPRISE PROPOSAL

\$210,000_{/yr}

- Snowflake + dbt + Fivetran
- \$160k Data Engineer
- 6-Month Rollout
- Per-Seat Viewer Fees

OPEN LAKEHOUSE

\$0_{licenses}

- ✓ GCS + DuckDB + Cube
- ✓ Existing 2-Person Team
- ✓ 5-Day Delivery
- ✓ Unlimited Viewers

Three Rules for Modern BI.

1

Clarity Over Complexity

You do not need six-figure SaaS contracts to understand your margins.

2

Own Your Infrastructure

Open file formats on cloud storage eliminate expensive vendor lock-in.

3

Upskill, Don't Bloat

Your existing technical team can run modern open-source data systems.



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END • SUMMARY